

3 Rules That Make Fat Loss Almost Impossible to Fail

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 25, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vilbL59okgw> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Getting fat happens by default — just 200 extra daily calories adds 20 lbs per year. Brandon Carter's 3 rules (track macros with AI, calculate personal targets, get accountability) make staying lean almost foolproof.

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Why Getting Fat Is Shockingly Easy 0:00

- Fat gain is purely a math problem: consuming more calories than you burn
 - Your body doesn't need a big surplus to accumulate serious fat over time
- **200 calories over maintenance every day for one year = 20 lbs of fat gained**
 - Basis: 1 lb of fat = 3,500 calories; $200 \text{ cal/day} \times 365 \text{ days} = 73,000 \text{ cal} \div 3,500 = \sim 20 \text{ lbs}$
 - 200 calories is an almost invisible amount:
 - Two bananas
 - An extra handful of nuts
 - Sauces alone (he later shows a small portion of sauce logged at ~200 calories)
- Even 100 calories over maintenance = **10 lbs of fat per year**
 - Do that for several years in a row and the result is severe obesity
- Getting fat happens *on accident*; getting lean requires deliberate action
- "Look around — it is the default state of America."

Rule 1: Track Your Calories and Macros (Using AI) 1:33

- Brandon has tracked calories and macros for **20 consecutive years** (started pre-iPhone with notebooks)
 - Used paper notebooks back when MyFitnessPal didn't exist
 - MyFitnessPal simplified it to entering numbers into a phone — "doesn't get more simpler than that"
- **Now even easier: use an AI chatbot (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini) as a conversational calorie tracker**
 - He uses a custom prompt he's built — DM him the word **"tracking"** on Instagram (@KingKeto) and automation sends it instantly
 - The prompt is too long to post in captions or description
- How his AI tracking workflow works (shown step-by-step in the video):
 - Tell the AI what you ate (e.g., "50 grams of blueberries, some egg whites") — it returns calories and macros for that meal plus a running daily total
 - Take a **photo of the back of a protein shake** — the AI reads the label and logs it automatically
 - Ask the AI mid-day "what's left?" and it tells you remaining protein, carbs, and calories

- If you make a mistake (he typed "chicken wings" when he meant "chicken legs"), the AI corrects and recalculates — "I like when Claude be like 'yo my fault man, I'm sorry'"
- Photograph a meal you won't weigh (e.g., Caesar salad) and the AI estimates it — you can add notes like "I'm not eating the croutons"
- Weigh sauces and condiments — his sugar-free honey mustard came in at **~200 calories** for a small portion, illustrating how invisible calories accumulate
- At end of day, input calories burned from **Oura Ring** data → AI calculates your exact caloric deficit for the day
- Say "end the day" → AI logs everything into a **Notion database** automatically
- Why most people are shocked when they first start tracking:
 - People trying to lose weight: "I had no idea I was eating that much"
 - People trying to gain weight: "I can't gain weight no matter what" → turns out they're eating only ~1,000 calories/day
 - Brandon has been a personal trainer for **27 years** and this reaction is universal among new clients

The moment you start tracking, you realize you have no idea how many calories you're actually consuming — and that ignorance is exactly what keeps people fat.

📍 Rule 2: Calculate Your Exact Daily Calorie and Protein Targets 8:50

- You can't track effectively without knowing your **target** — calories and macros to hit each day
- He built a **free tool called the Ripped Road Map** (link in video description)
 - 100% free; he coded it himself
- How the Ripped Road Map works:
 - Select male or female
 - Enter age, height, and current weight
 - Upload a photo of yourself (shirt off preferred; women use workout clothes or a bathing suit)
 - AI analyzes the photo to estimate body fat percentage
 - Returns: estimated body fat %, fat mass, lean mass, goal body weight, and daily macro targets
- Example output from his own assessment:

Metric	Value
Estimated body fat	~10%
Fat mass	20 lbs
Lean mass	180 lbs
Current weight	~200 lbs
Goal (shredded) body fat	8%
Fat to lose	4 lbs
Goal body weight	196 lbs
Daily calories	2,170
Daily protein target	200 g

- The tool also shows a **week-by-week projection for 20 weeks** so you know exactly how long it will take to reach your goal
- **Protein is the most important macro** — here's why he prioritizes it above all else:
 - The Thermic Effect of Food (TEF): your body burns calories just to digest food, and the amount varies by macronutrient:

Macronutrient	Calories burned during digestion (TEF)
Fat	~0–3%
Carbohydrates	~5–15%
Protein	~20–30%

- If you eat 100 calories of protein, your body only **absorbs** 70–80 of those calories
- "It's a cheat code" – like a cashback credit card on every meal
- Protein also keeps you fuller longer because it takes more time and effort to digest
- Carbs spike dopamine, are easy to digest, and make you want to eat more – harder to control intake
- **Protein target: use your TOTAL body weight in lbs, not lean mass**
 - Rationale: eating more protein means more TEF burn-off, so even a 300 lb person should eat ~300 g protein
 - At 20–30% TEF, a large portion of those extra protein calories get burned in digestion anyway
 - "It's only 50 grams more than what I eat every day"
- Carbs vs. fat split: he says it **doesn't matter** — adjust the slider to whatever suits your preference
 - He personally eats keto (very low carb, high fat)
 - High-carb works too; balanced is fine
 - "What really matters when it comes to body composition is the calories and the protein"
 - Note: you *can* eat berries on keto (low net carbs)

Rule 3: Get Accountability — a Friend or Coach 14:09

- Consistency is hardest when **nobody is watching**
 - Same principle as a workout partner: you're far more likely to go to the gym if someone is waiting for you
 - Without accountability, the excuses flow easily — he calls them **"mediocre mantras"**:
 - "I can take a day off"
 - "I went a bunch of days in a row, I don't have to go today"
 - "You gotta live a little"
 - "One won't hurt"
- Two accountability options:
 - **Option A — Accountability partner:** find a friend who's also dieting, share your food log with each other daily, turn it into a friendly competition
 - **Option B — Hire a coach:** ideally one who will review your calorie tracking *every day* (he notes most gym coaches won't do this)
- With tracking + a personal target + accountability: "it's super difficult to fail"
 - "Not only will you not get fat like everyone else, but you're also going to get in the best shape of your life"

Bonus Mentions and Resources 15:23

- **Free Ripped Road Map tool** — link in video description; calculates your calorie/macro targets and 20-week projection
- **AI tracking prompt** — DM the word "tracking" to @KingKeto on Instagram; automation sends it immediately
- **Live training event — August 2nd** (free):
 - Topic: how to make an extra \$300–\$500/day as an online trainer using AI
 - Brandon's background: taught 15,000+ people to grow online fitness businesses; made over \$20 million online
 - Register via link in description